

JEFFERSON RODRIGUEZ NAJERA

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Research interests: *development economics; impact evaluation and applied microeconometrics; public investment, firm dynamics, and innovation; local and regional development.*

EDUCATION

University of Virginia, Charlottesville, VA May 2026

Frank Batten School of Leadership & Public Policy

Master of Public Policy

- GPA: 3.80 out of 4.00
- Awards and Recognitions: Fulbright Scholar, Batten Family Bicentennial Scholars Fellow
- Relevant Coursework: *Research Methods & Data Analysis I-II; Economics of Public Policy I-II; Advanced Topics in Impact Evaluation; Regional Economic Modeling; Poverty Reduction & Aid Policy (Development Economics); Applied Policy Project I-II*

University of Costa Rica, San José, Costa Rica May 2020

School of Public Administration

Licentiate's degree in Public Administration

- GPA: 9.45 out of 10; specialization in Public Budgeting & Finance
- Awards and Recognitions: Graduation with an honorific mention
- Relevant Coursework: *Impact Evaluation; General Statistics; Calculus I; Mathematics for Economic Sciences; Public Finance*

Bachelor of Arts in Public Administration Aug 2018

- GPA: 9.03 out of 10; Graduation with honorific mention

University of Los Andes, Bogotá, Colombia Jan – Jun 2018

- Immersive, semester-long study abroad; International Studies Office Scholarship (two awards)
- Relevant Coursework: *Introduction to Policy Analysis; The Right to the City; Public Management Practice*

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Virginia, Charlottesville, VA Aug 2025 – May 2026

Independent Researcher - Impact Evaluation of the National Judicial Facilitators Service (SNFJ), supervised by Prof. Daniel Player

- Designed and executed a full-cycle quasi-experimental impact evaluation of a nationwide judicial-access program, exploiting its staggered rollout across 76 cantons (2013–2022).
- Estimated program effects with staggered difference-in-differences estimator, supported by two-way fixed-effects models, event studies, Poisson PPML, and a full battery of placebo, robustness, and falsification tests.
- Assembled an administrative panel dataset from raw institutional records (2000–2025) across contraventional, family, domestic-violence, and child-support courts, managing the full Stata pipeline; produced the first causal evidence on the program. Reproducible code sample public on GitHub.

Center for Social Innovation, University of Virginia, Charlottesville, VA Mar 2025 – May 2026

Research Assistant - Development economics, supervised by Prof. Molly Lipscomb

- Electricity Subsidies and Firm Performance (Argentina): sourced and built a nationwide firm-level and regulatory dataset, expanding the analysis from a single province to the whole country and enabling statistically significant, economically relevant findings; contributed to specifications, figures, and interpretation.
- Public Investment and Development Outcomes (Colombia): mapped data availability across 10+ countries; built a territorial administrative dataset (Terridata) via Python web scraping and APIs, cleaned in Stata; ran OLS, instrumental variables, LASSO, and machine-learning models with robustness checks.
- Documented all work with fully commented scripts, data visualizations, and technical memoranda.

Innovaap / CICAP, University of Costa Rica, San José Jul 2018 – Jul 2022

Research Coordinator - Public-employment perceptions study

- Led a team of undergraduate researchers and coordinated every phase (survey design, analysis, interpretation) of a peer-reviewed study on public-employment perceptions in Costa Rica's public administration, published in *Administrar lo Público* (not a listed author).

POLICY & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

National Emergency Commission (CNE), Costa Rica

Aug 2025 – May 2026

Independent Consultant - Master's thesis

- Full-cycle policy analysis (systematic literature review, cost-benefit evaluation, M&E design) of four relocation alternatives for flood-induced displacement in Esparza, delivered with a phased implementation plan.

Judicial Branch of Costa Rica, San José

Sep 2021 – Jun 2024

Senior Policy Analyst - Open Justice Program

- Led the nationwide Open Data Protocol, doubling the institution's public datasets (2022–2023); directed the geospatial-model-based urban expansion of the facilitators program (+15% national coverage, +7% facilitators in six months).

CICAP, University of Costa Rica, San José

Sep 2019 – Aug 2021

Senior Project Manager

- Led organizational-redesign and mixed-methods regulatory studies (JPS redesign, 911 Emergency System, ARESEP public-transport study) for national institutions.

Idea Pública / Innovaap, UCR, San José

Jul 2018 – Jul 2022

Co-founder & Area Coordinator

- Co-founded Costa Rica's first public-innovation lab; deployed a policy-analysis methodology across 15 municipalities with the OAS Trust for the Americas.

PUBLICATIONS

- Rodríguez-Nájera, J. (2026). From Invisibility to Evidence: Reflections on Inclusive Participatory Data Collection in the Costa Rican Judiciary. *Revista del CLAD Reforma y Democracia*, (95). (Accepted – pending publication)
- Rodríguez Nájera, J.; Barquero Gamboa, C. y Hernández Cruz, O. (2021). Strategic linking of cultural public policies: case analysis of the cantons of Belén, Santa Ana and Escazú. *Compilación Administrar lo Público*, p. 70-82; 9na. Edición, Vol. 1 Núm 1. ISBN 978-9968-932-41-7, San José, CR. Licencia CC BY 4.0.
- Rodríguez Nájera, J.; Barrantes Herrera, A. y Hurtado Herrera, A. (2020). Cultural public policy implementation: compared study of the management models of Santa Ana, Escazú, and Belén territories. *Universidad de Costa Rica, Facultad de Ciencias Económicas*.
- Rodríguez, J.; Fernández, C.; Calderón, C.; Calderón, J. & Umaña, J. (2018). Collaboration networks for local innovation. *Organization for American States (OAS), Trust for the Americas, and Innovaap UCR*. San José, Costa Rica.

SKILLS

- Software: Stata (advanced); Python; R; Power BI, Tableau; Excel; MS Project
- Methods: Difference-in-differences (staggered); causal inference; instrumental variables; LASSO and machine learning; event studies; robustness and falsification testing; geospatial analysis; mixed-methods and survey research
- Certifications: Certified in Behavioral Economics (IDB–INDES); Python Fundamentals; Power BI; Creative Coding (CIID Copenhagen)
- Language: Spanish (native speaker); English (advanced proficiency)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Virginia, Charlottesville, VA

Jan – May 2026

Teaching Assistant - Leadership in the Public Arena

University of Costa Rica, San José

Mar 2020 – Jul 2024

Junior Lecturer, School of Public Administration